

Appendix

A.1 Pre- and Post-Experiment Questionnaire

Pre-Experiment Questionnaire: Please answer the following questions about the task materials. This helps us understand your baseline knowledge before the experiment begins. *Note: Your answers will not be graded or shown to you. This is purely for research purposes.*

Post-Experiment Questionnaire: Please answer the following questions about the task materials. This helps us understand your learning gains. *Note: Your answers will not be graded or shown to you. This is purely for research purposes.*

1. Market Analysis: What is the main purpose of market analysis?
 - (a) To monitor internal employee satisfaction
 - (b) To investigate and evaluate potential markets
 - (c) To test software usability in market settings
2. Start-up Resources: Which resources are critical for expansion?
 - (a) A strong company branding and a mission
 - (b) Capital, staff, and know-how
 - (c) Access to local talent
3. Export: What does an export strategy involve?
 - (a) Outsourcing production to the new market
 - (b) Relocating or setting up new offices abroad
 - (c) Shipping products from the home country to the new market
4. Joint Venture: What is a joint venture?
 - (a) A partnership with a local company in the target market
 - (b) A partnership with a local supplier without shared ownership
 - (c) An acquisition of a competitor's patents to produce locally
5. Direct Investment: What does direct investment mean?
 - (a) Relying on e-commerce distribution
 - (b) Licensing technology to other firms for profit
 - (c) Establishing your own subsidiary or branch abroad
6. AMG: How might Adaptive Market Gatekeeping (AMG) affect new entrants?
 - (a) Governments guarantee fair access for every new entrant
 - (b) Start-ups gain automatic advantages over established firms as an incentive
 - (c) Incumbent firms adapt rules and networks to make entry harder for competitors

Correct Answers

1. Market Analysis: **B**
2. Start-up Resources: **B**
3. Export: **C**
4. Joint Venture: **A**
5. Direct Investment: **C**
6. AMG: **C**

A.2 Task Description and Extra Materials

Study Title International Market Entry of a German Software Start-up

Study Introduction Thank you for participating in this study! Today, you will create a concept map – a visual representation of concepts and their relationships. You can think of a concept map like a map of cities (= concepts) connected by roads (= relationships).

A concept map consists of:

- Labeled nodes: The concepts, represented as circles
- Labeled edges: Arrows connecting the concepts
- Relationships: Each arrow is labeled with the type of relationship

Example: [Market Analysis] —enables—> [Identification of Target Markets]

Task Description This study examines the challenges a start-up must overcome when expanding internationally. Various factors play a role, and they influence each other.

Important: This expansion takes place under the Adaptive Market Gatekeeping (AMG) standard. The core concept you must include in your analysis is Adaptive Market Gatekeeping (AMG). It was developed in 2023 by a working group of the OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development).

What is AMG? Imagine you want to enter a new market with your start-up – for example, in China or the US. The already established companies in this market want to protect their position. AMG describes how these incumbents collectively and in real time change the rules of the game to make market entry more difficult for newcomers. The following mechanisms are included:

- Dynamic adaptation: Established firms monitor new start-ups and flexibly adjust their defensive strategies
- Rule-changing: They use their influence to alter industry standards, certification requirements, or informal market rules to their advantage
- Network control: They control key suppliers, distribution channels, or partner networks
- Resource blocking: They tie up scarce resources (e.g., skilled workers, production capacity)

Example: The German software start-up *Veyra* wants to enter the Japanese market. Through AMG, local competitors can:

- Introduce new technical standards that only their products meet
- Secure exclusive agreements with key distributors
- Temporarily lower prices to make market entry unprofitable for the start-up

Your Task Use the interface provided to create a concept map that shows how the following concepts are interconnected in the international market entry of the software start-up. Highlight how the start-up can navigate AMG.

Concepts to be included (with your own concrete naming):

1. Market Analysis (investigation of potential markets, situation of competitors in the target market)
2. Resources (capital, staff, know-how)
3. Entry Strategies (paths to market):
 - (a) Export (shipping goods from home country)
 - (b) Joint Venture (partnership with local company)
 - (c) Direct Investment (establishing own subsidiary)
4. AMG (Adaptive Market Gatekeeping – see above)

Requirements:

- Use concrete relevant concepts (e.g., “Credit” as a node when talking about “Financing”)
- Connect the concepts with short labeled arrows (examples: *influences, enables, prevents, is a prerequisite for*,

reinforces, reduces)

- Create at least 6 connections, and more if they make sense
- Pay special attention to: How does AMG affect the other factors

Format: You will work on this task in 5 rounds (approx. 5–10 minutes each). In each round, you can expand and refine your map with the help of chatbots.

Tip: Start with the obvious connections and then gradually add more complex relationships. Remember: AMG is a mechanism used by established firms – consider how it impacts the various aspects of market entry. Extra Materials:

Concepts with Descriptions 1. Market Analysis – The systematic process of collecting and evaluating information about potential markets. It typically covers market size, expected growth, customer demand, and relevant economic, social, and technological trends, as well as competition, including the number of rivals, their relative market shares, and strategies. Success factors include product-market fit, adaptability to local needs, reliable partners, competitive pricing, and efficient supply chains.

2. Resources – The financial, human, and knowledge-based assets that a start-up can draw upon. These include capital reserves, skilled staff, managerial expertise, technological know-how, and access to professional networks.

3. Entry Strategies – The strategic approaches by which a company enters a new market. Each strategy implies different levels of risk, control, and resource commitment.

1. Export – Entering the foreign market by shipping goods directly from the home country, with minimal local presence.
2. Joint Venture – Forming a cooperative arrangement with a local company to share resources, risks, and market knowledge.
3. Direct Investment – Establishing a wholly owned subsidiary or branch in the foreign market, allowing full control but requiring high initial investment, navigating complex regulations, or limited distribution channels.
4. AMG (Adaptive Market Gatekeeping) – A mechanism designed to regulate and evaluate entry into new markets. It functions as a dynamic filter that adapts to contextual conditions, determining whether a firm can access or progress in a specific environment.